

Stacey Menley – Professional Development Roadmap

Aspiring SOC Analyst Cybersecurity

Objective

To transition into a full-time SOC Analyst role by strengthening my technical capabilities, earning the CompTIA CySA+ certification, and expanding hands-on experience in network segmentation, log analysis, and Python scripting. This 120-day roadmap outlines my strategic development plan aligned with the Othentk junior SOC internship and long-term employment goals.

Days 1–30: Foundation & Visibility

- Apply for paid internships, IT roles, volunteer projects, and freelance opportunities
- Personal branding and expand professional network on LinkedIn & cybersecurity forums
- Research Raspberry Pi and Cisco switch models for home lab setup
- Begin structured Python learning and practice basic scripting
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Days 31–60: Labs & Portfolio Expansion

- Build Raspberry Pi lab with VLAN segmentation and basic logging
- Develop Python mini-projects (e.g., log parser, subnet calculator) and add to portfolio
- Simulate phishing detection and alert response workflows
- Update LinkedIn and Indeed profiles to reflect new skills and projects
- Join 1–2 cybersecurity communities and schedule informational interviews
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Days 61–90: Certification & Real-World Readiness

- Build Raspberry Pi honeypot or pfSense firewall lab
- Draft a SOC playbook or incident response cheat sheet
- Begin CompTIA CySA+ study

Extended Goal: 120-Day Milestone

- Revisit and complete TryHackMe SOC Analyst pathway
- Continue CySA+ preparation and target certification completion
- Expand lab documentation and share updated portfolio with mentors and hiring managers

Long-Term Vision

To specialize in cybersecurity and protect critical infrastructure as a SOC Analyst. I'm committed to continuous learning, hands-on experimentation, and supporting mission-driven teams with integrity, precision, and resilience.